

Exosphere

This is the highest layer of Earth's atmosphere, where it merges into space. Only a few, very thin wisps of gas are found this high above our planet. It would be impossible to breathe here!

Earth's atmosphere

Earth is surrounded by a thick layer of gases, called the atmosphere. These gases protect Earth from the Sun's rays, keeping temperatures on our planet at a comfortable level. Earth's atmosphere is divided into a number of distinct layers. At the outer edge of the atmosphere, there is no clear boundary. It just fades into space.

Thermosphere

Unlike in other layers of Earth's atmosphere, temperatures here increase as you go higher, some parts rising to 2,000°C (3,600°F)! Satellites, including the International Space Station, orbit Earth in the thermosphere.

Satellites

These orbit Earth in the thermosphere and the exosphere. We use them to make phone calls and watch TV. Scientists also use satellites to find out more about space.



Aurora

These bright lights appear in the thermosphere when particles from the Sun fall into Earth's atmosphere.



! WOW!

Without some of the gases in its atmosphere, Earth would be **too cold to live on!**